



RISE & SHINE ABA LLC

Empowering children to reach their full potential

CLOCK IN / OUT & TIME RECORDING POLICY

Document v1.0 · Effective May 2026 · Annual Review Required

Governed by the laws of the State of New York

1. Purpose

Accurate time tracking is essential to Rise & Shine ABA's operations. It protects you, our clients, and the company. This Policy explains how to clock in and out, the rules every employee must follow, how to correct honest mistakes, and what happens when time records are inaccurate or fraudulent.

Accurate time records:

- **Protect you** by ensuring you are paid correctly for every hour worked.
- **Protect our clients** by creating an accurate record of every service delivered.
- **Protect the company** by supporting compliant insurance billing and meeting payer audit requirements.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to all hourly employees of Rise & Shine ABA, including Registered Behavior Technicians, Behavior Technicians, supervised fieldwork students, and any other employee paid on an hourly basis. Salaried staff follow separate time-tracking procedures as described in their offer letter.

3. How to Clock In and Out

Time is recorded in Artemis (our EHR and timekeeping system). The general procedure is:

To Be Customized — Artemis-Specific Steps

This section will be completed with Artemis-specific click-by-click instructions by the Director of Operations before deployment. Insert: (1) how to log into Artemis, (2) how to start a session timer at the beginning of every session, (3) how to end and confirm the timer, (4) how to verify the recorded time before signing the session note, (5) how to view your timesheet.

Until the customized Artemis steps are added above, follow the general principles in Section 4. If you are unsure how to record time correctly in Artemis, ask your supervising BCBA before your next session.

4. Rules

4.1 Clock In Only When You Are Present and Ready to Work

- **In-home or community sessions:** Clock in only when you are physically present at the session location and the session is beginning.
- **Telehealth sessions:** Clock in only at the start of the authorized telehealth session, not when you log into the platform.
- **Travel time:** Travel time is not session time. Do not clock in for client services while traveling.

4.2 Clock Out Immediately When the Session Ends

- Clock out at the moment the session ends — not when you finish writing the note, not when you leave the building.
- Sessions extending beyond the authorized duration require advance approval from the supervising BCBA. Unauthorized extensions cannot be billed.

4.3 Record Exact Times — No Rounding

- **Times must be recorded to the minute.** Do not round 2:07 to 2:00 or 3:52 to 4:00.
- The session note duration must exactly match the time recorded in Artemis.

4.4 No Buddy Punching

Clocking in or out for another employee — or asking another employee to clock in or out for you — is **buddy punching**. This is timekeeping fraud and is grounds for **immediate termination**, regardless of length of employment or prior performance.

4.5 GPS and Location Verification

Artemis may use GPS or geolocation to verify that you are at the authorized session location at the time of clock-in for in-home, school, and community sessions. This is a payer requirement for many insurers, including Medicaid. By using Artemis, you consent to location verification during work hours.

4.6 Lunch and Unpaid Breaks

- If you take a meal break of 30 minutes or longer, you must clock out for the duration of the break and clock back in when you return to work.
- Short rest breaks (under 20 minutes) are paid and do not require clocking out.
- New York Labor Law meal break entitlements apply — see the Employee Handbook §4 for details.

5. Correcting Honest Mistakes

If you discover an error in your time record — for example, you forgot to clock out, the system did not capture your clock-in, or you accidentally clocked into the wrong client — request a correction promptly:

1. **Submit a Time Correction Request** through Artemis (or to your supervising BCBA if Artemis correction is unavailable) **within 48 hours** of the original time entry.
2. **Include:** the date and original time entry, the correct time, and a brief explanation of what happened.
3. **BCBA approval is required** for all time corrections. The BCBA may request additional verification (e.g., session note, parent confirmation, GPS log) before approving.
4. **Approved corrections are documented** in the Artemis time correction log and your timesheet is updated.

Pattern of frequent corrections — even when each individual correction is honest — may trigger a review of your timekeeping practices and additional training.

6. Fraudulent Time Entry

Zero Tolerance — Fraudulent Time Entry

Falsifying any time record is timekeeping fraud and is treated as fraud against the company, against insurance payers, and (where Medicaid is involved) against the federal and state government. Fraudulent time entry is grounds for immediate termination of employment, with no warning and no progressive discipline.

Fraudulent time entry includes, but is not limited to:

- Clocking in for a session that did not occur
- Clocking in earlier than the actual session start, or clocking out later than the actual session end, to inflate billable hours
- Buddy punching (clocking in or out for another person, or having another person do so for you)
- Recording session times that do not match the actual time you spent with the client
- Submitting a time correction that you know to be inaccurate
- Reporting telehealth sessions as in-person, or vice versa, to obtain a higher reimbursement rate

In addition to immediate termination, fraudulent time entry may result in:

- **Civil legal action** by the company to recover damages and any wages paid based on fraudulent records.
- **Reporting to the BACB** (Behavior Analyst Certification Board), which may result in revocation of your RBT or BCBA credential.
- **Reporting to the New York State Medicaid Fraud Control Unit** if Medicaid funds were involved. Medicaid fraud carries serious civil and potential criminal penalties.
- **Reporting to other affected payers** for commercial insurance fraud.
- **Criminal prosecution** under federal and state fraud statutes where applicable.

7. Time Records Must Match Session Notes

Your time record in Artemis and your session note must reflect the exact same start time, end time, and duration. They are two parts of the same record.

Discrepancies between time records and session notes — for example, a session note showing a 2-hour session paired with a clock-in/out totaling 1 hour 45 minutes — will trigger an automatic compliance review. Repeated discrepancies are treated as a serious documentation and timekeeping issue.

Before signing your session note, verify that the time in Artemis matches what you actually worked. Correct any discrepancy through the Time Correction Request process in Section 5.

8. Consequences of Non-Compliance

Non-fraudulent timekeeping issues — late clock-ins, frequent corrections, occasional discrepancies — are treated as performance issues using a tiered approach:

1. **First offense:** Verbal warning, documented in personnel file. Coaching from supervising BCBA.
2. **Second offense:** Written warning, documented in personnel file. Required timekeeping refresher training.
3. **Continued issues:** Suspension of new client assignments. Existing assignments may be reassigned.
4. **Productivity bonuses:** Any timekeeping-tied incentive compensation will be forfeited for the affected pay period.
5. **Chronic non-compliance:** May result in termination of employment, in accordance with at-will employment and applicable progressive discipline procedures.

Note: These tiered consequences apply only to *honest* timekeeping errors. Fraudulent time entry is governed by Section 6 and results in immediate termination.

Wage Protection Notice

Rise & Shine ABA will pay all wages owed for time actually worked in accordance with applicable federal and New York State wage and hour law. The consequences in this Section relate to disciplinary action, future client assignments, and incentive compensation. They do not affect wages already earned for hours worked. If you believe a time record needs correction, follow the process in Section 5.

Questions about this Policy should be directed to your supervising BCBA, the Director of Operations, or the Compliance Officer.

Acknowledgment of this Policy is captured on the Documentation & Time Recording Acknowledgment Form, which must be signed at hire and re-acknowledged annually.